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CLAY

OH JUNO!



The kiln is my therapist

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The kiln is my therapist

Every Sunday I load the kiln and leave my phone in the car. Eleven hours of heat. Nothing I can rush, nothing I can fix by refreshing an inbox.

I used to think slow was a luxury. Now I think slow is the business plan. The mugs that sell out are the ones I made when I was not trying to sell anything.

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> SLOW IS NOT THE OPPOSITE OF AMBITIOUS. SLOW IS HOW AMBITIOUS PEOPLE STAY IN LOVE WITH THE WORK.

So this is your sign. Pick one thing this week you refuse to rush.

Price it like you mean it

My first bowls were twelve dollars. I was so scared nobody would buy them that I priced them like an apology.

Here is what changed when I tripled the price:

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- the right people started buying
- they sent photos of the bowls on their tables
- I stopped resenting the hours

Your price is the first story people hear about your work. Make it a good one. Mine now says: this was made slowly, by hand, by someone who knows exactly what it is worth.

Studio rules (taped above the wheel)

- Glaze is a mood, not a mistake.
- Music loud, notifications off.
- Every wonky cup has a home.
- Snacks are a business expense.

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♥ If it cracks, it was practice.

I wrote these on a receipt the week everything went wrong. Three kiln loads cracked, a wholesale order fell through and I cried into a bucket of slip. The rules stayed up. So did I.

What happened at craft night

Twelve strangers, one long table, a lot of clay under fingernails. I thought I was teaching them to pinch a pot. They thought they were coming for a hobby.

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By ten o'clock two of them had swapped numbers, one had quit her job in her head, and everyone had made something lopsided and perfect.

Nobody posted a single story. They were too busy being there.

That is the whole point of the room. Come to the next one. Bring a friend who needs it.



A letter to the girl starting out

You do not need a website yet. You do not need a logo, a launch plan or a business card with foil on it.

You need ten people who love what you make, and the nerve to ask them to tell ten more.

Make the thing. Show the thing. Charge for the thing. Then make it again, a little braver.

> EVERYTHING I WANT WANTS ME MORE.

See you at the wheel.



PASS IT ON

THANK YOU FOR READING

Slow is not the opposite of ambitious. Slow is how ambitious people stay in love with the work.





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JUNO MARLOW

MADE WITH ZINE MACHINE